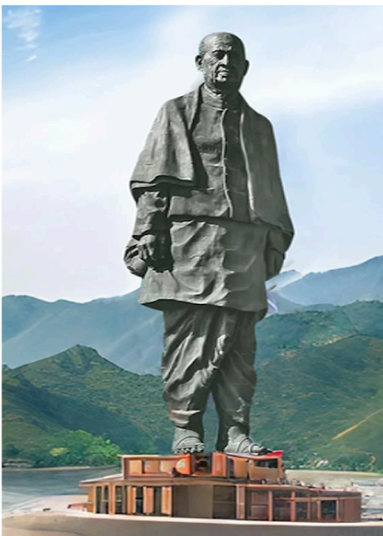


General Knowledge

Static GK

STUDY NOTES

National Symbols



National Symbols



National Symbols Overview:

- India's national symbols reflect its rich cultural **heritage**, **values**, and **natural beauty**.
- The Tricolor flag symbolizes **unity**, **sacrifice**, and **progress**, while Jana Gana Mana and **Vande Mataram** express national pride and devotion to the motherland.
- The Lion Capital stands for **justice**, **courage**, and **truth**.
- The Royal Bengal Tiger, known for **strength**, and the Indian Peacock, for **beauty** and **grace**, highlight India's biodiversity.
- The Lotus, **symbolizing purity**, and the Banyan Tree, symbolizing wisdom and immortality, represent spiritual and natural values.
- The Ganga River and Gangetic Dolphin reflect the nation's reverence for its **rivers** and **environment**.
- The Mango represents **tropical abundance**, while the King Cobra signifies **mystery** and **power**.
- The Indian Elephant honours **cultural significance**, and the Saka calendar and ₹ symbolize continuity in **history** and **economic** growth.
- These symbols connect the nation's past, present, and future, **evoking unity**, **identity**, and **respect for nature**.

Key reasons for having national symbols:

- **Identity:** It represents the country's unique identity and heritage.
- **Unity:** It fosters a sense of national pride and unity among citizens.

- **Cultural Representation:** It showcases the nation's history, culture, and values.
- **International Recognition:** It helps us to represent the country globally.
- **Patriotism:** It inspires patriotism and emotional connection to the nation.
- **Symbol of Sovereignty:** It reflects the nation's independence and sovereignty.
- **Environmental Significance:** It highlights the nation's commitment to preserving its natural flora, fauna, and ecosystems.
- **Historical Legacy:** It Preserves and honors historical achievements and milestones in the nation's journey.

National Symbol	Details
National Flag	Tricolor (saffron, white, green) with Ashoka Chakra
National Anthem	"Jana Gana Mana" by Rabindranath Tagore
National Song	"Vande Mataram" by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee
National Emblem	Lion Capital of Ashoka, "Satyameva Jayate" below
National Animal	Royal Bengal Tiger (<i>Panthera tigris tigris</i>)
National Bird	Indian Peacock (<i>Pavo cristatus</i>)
National Flower	Lotus (<i>Nelumbo nucifera</i>)
National Tree	Indian Banyan (<i>Ficus benghalensis</i>)
National River	Ganga
National Aquatic Animal	Gangetic Dolphin (<i>Platanista gangetica</i>)
National Fruit	Mango (<i>Mangifera indica</i>)
National Reptile	King Cobra (<i>Ophiophagus Hannah</i>)
National Heritage Animal	Indian Elephant
National Calendar	Saka calendar (adopted in 1957)
National Currency Symbol	Indian Rupee (₹)

National Flag:

- The Tricolor consists of **saffron** (courage and sacrifice), **white** (peace and truth), and **green** (prosperity).
- The **Ashoka Chakra** (navy blue wheel) has **24** spokes, symbolizing the eternal wheel of law.
- It was adopted on **July 22, 1947**, the flag was inspired by the design of the Indian National Congress flag, designed by Pingali Venkayya.
- It represents India's commitment to diversity, peace, and progress, while the Ashoka Chakra emphasizes justice and righteousness.



National Anthem:

- "Jana Gana Mana": Written by **Rabindranath Tagore** in **1911**, it was officially adopted as the national anthem on **January 24, 1950**.
- It was first sung at the **1911 Indian National Congress** session in **Kolkata**.
- It celebrates the unity and diversity of India, praising the spirit of all Indian regions and cultures under one nation.



National Song:

- "Vande Mataram": Written by **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** in the **1870s**, it was part of his novel **Anandamath**.
- It was first Sung during India's independence movement, especially by revolutionaries.
- A tribute to the motherland, it symbolizes devotion to India and played a key role in igniting patriotic fervour during the freedom struggle.



National Emblem:

- **Lion Capital of Ashoka:** This emblem features four Asiatic lions standing back-to-back, with the wheel (Ashoka Chakra) at the base, and the inscription "**Satyameva Jayate**" (Truth Alone Triumphs) from the Mundaka Upanishad.
- It was taken from the **Ashoka Pillar** in **Sarnath**, this symbol was adopted on January **26, 1950**, the day India became a republic.
- It reflects India's commitment to peace, courage, and the moral authority of truth.



National Animal:

- **Royal Bengal Tiger:** Recognized for its majestic appearance and strength, the Royal Bengal Tiger is one of the largest wild cats.
- It was declared the national animal in **1973** to mark the beginning of **Project Tiger**, a conservation initiative.
- It represents India's rich wildlife and commitment to wildlife conservation, symbolizing strength and power.



National Bird:

- **Indian Peacock:** It is known for its vibrant and beautiful plumage, the Indian peacock is a symbol of grace, beauty, and pride.
- **History:** Declared the national bird in 1963 for its religious and cultural significance.
- **Significance:** Revered in Indian mythology, art, and folklore, the peacock is associated with beauty, rain, and divine protection.



National Flower:

- ★ **Lotus:** The lotus flower grows in muddy waters yet remains pure and beautiful, making it a powerful symbol of purity and spirituality in Indian culture.
- ★ **History:** The lotus has been used in Indian art, architecture, and religion for centuries.
- ★ **Significance:** It represents purity of heart and mind, resilience, and spiritual enlightenment in Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain traditions.



National Tree:

- ★ **Indian Banyan:** It is known for its immense size and long lifespan, the banyan tree is a symbol of immortality and shelter.
- ★ **History:** Banyan trees have been central to village life in India for centuries, often serving as a meeting point and shade-giving tree.
- ★ **Significance:** It represents eternal life due to its seemingly endless expansion and longevity, symbolizing wisdom and continuity.



National River:

- ★ **Ganga (Ganges):** The Ganga is considered sacred in Hinduism and supports millions of livelihoods along its banks.
- ★ **History:** Revered as a goddess in Hindu mythology, the Ganga holds deep religious and cultural significance.
- ★ **Significance:** Beyond its spiritual importance, it is vital for agriculture and sustains millions of people, making it a lifeline for India.



National Aquatic Animal:

- ★ **Gangetic Dolphin:** Found in the Ganga and Brahmaputra rivers, the Gangetic dolphin is blind and uses echolocation to navigate.
- ★ **History:** Declared the national aquatic animal in 2009 to raise awareness about its endangered status.
- ★ **Significance:** Represents the health of river ecosystems and the need for conservation efforts to protect freshwater biodiversity.



National Fruit:

- ★ **Mango:** Known as the "King of Fruits," mangoes have been cultivated in India for over 4,000 years and are deeply embedded in Indian culture.
- ★ **History:** The mango was enjoyed by emperors and featured in ancient Indian texts.
- ★ **Significance:** It represents tropical abundance, fertility, and prosperity, symbolizing the richness of India's agricultural tradition.



National Reptile:

- ★ **King Cobra:** The world's longest venomous snake, the King Cobra is both feared and revered in India.
- ★ **History:** It is featured in Indian mythology and folklore, it has been a symbol of mystery and power.
- ★ **Significance:** It represents strength, protection, and the enigmatic aspects of nature, symbolizing India's reverence for its wildlife.



National Heritage Animal:

- ★ **Indian Elephant:** Indian elephants have long been associated with royalty, religion, and power.
- ★ **History:** Elephants have been integral to Indian history, from battlefields to religious ceremonies.
- ★ **Significance:** As a keystone species, the Indian elephant represents cultural heritage and the nation's commitment to wildlife conservation.



National Calendar:

- ★ **Saka Calendar:** The Saka calendar was officially adopted as the national calendar on **March 22, 1957**, for civil purposes alongside the Gregorian calendar.
- ★ **History:** The Saka era began in **78 AD**, and the calendar is still used for **Hindu festivals**.
- ★ **Significance:** It reflects India's cultural continuity and traditional practices in keeping time, aligning with ancient Indian astronomy.



National Currency Symbol:

- ★ **Indian Rupee (₹):** The symbol ₹ was designed by **Udaya Kumar** and adopted in **2010**, combining the Devanagari letter "र" and the Roman letter "R."
- ★ **History:** The new symbol was introduced to give the Indian Rupee global recognition similar to other currencies like the **US** dollar or **Euro**.
- ★ **Significance:** It represents India's growing economic power and its integration into the global economy, blending Indian tradition with modernity.

